Figure 9. Pharmaceuticals

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Total spending per capita, US $[a]	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Retail pharmaceutical spending per capita, US $[b]	US 1752	Germany 1338	CHE 1193	Canada 1064	Japan 1026	Australia 947	France 851	Sweden 756	UK 635	NLD 568	Denmark 535	970
Prices, US $ per mo[d]												
Crestor (cholesterol)	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Lantus (diabetes)	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Advair (asthma)	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Humira (rheumatoid arthritis)	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
New chemical entities, No.[c]	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Pharmaceutical expenditure by financing type, % of total spending[e]												
Public spending	Germany 83	France 82	CHE 73	Japan 71	UK 70	NLD 69	Sweden 57	Australia 50	Denmark 39	Canada 36	US NA	63 (n = 10)
Private insurance	Canada 34	Denmark 6	France 6	CHE 4	Japan 1	NLD 1	Australia 0	Germany 0	UK 0	Sweden 0	US NA	5 (n = 10)
Private out-of-pocket spending	Denmark 55	Australia 50	Sweden 44	NLD 31	Canada 30	US 30	UK 30	Japan 28	CHE 24	Germany 16	France 13	32
Share of generics, % of total[g]												
Volume	Germany 84	Canada 79	NLD 79	UK 73	Australia 71	Denmark 70	Japan 54	France 43	Sweden 34	CHE 27	US NA	62 (n = 10)
Value	Germany 28	NLD 27	UK 27	Denmark 24	Canada 23	CHE 21	France 18	Sweden 17	Japan 17	Australia 16	US NA	22 (n = 10)
Antibiotic prescribing, defined daily doses per 1000 population[f]	France 24.7	Australia 19.3	UK 15.6	Denmark 14.4	Germany 12.1	Canada 10.5	Japan 9.9	Sweden 9.6	NLD 9.0	US NA	CHE NA	13.9 (n = 9)

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] Not updated: no public source reports total (retail plus hospital) pharmaceutical spending per capita on a common basis for most of these countries (the 2018 values came from IMS/IFPMA).

[b] Retail pharmaceuticals and other medical nondurables per capita, current US dollar purchasing power parities.

[c] Not updated: the 2018 counts (Daemmrich, 1982-2003, by originator country) have no current equivalent; EFPIA reports new chemical and biological entities for 2021-2025 only for the United States (140), Japan (33), and Europe as a whole (87).

[d] Not updated: the Bloomberg/SSR Health 2015 price comparison has not been repeated, and no single-methodology source compares monthly prices for these 4 products (now generic or biosimilar in most countries) across these countries.

[e] Retail pharmaceutical spending by financing scheme. US values are NA because employer and individual private insurance are now reported as compulsory schemes in the US health accounts, so public and private insurance shares are not comparable with 2018.

[f] Community (primary care) sector, defined daily doses per 1000 inhabitants per day; the United States reports prescriptions rather than defined daily doses.

[g] Market basis differs by country as in 2018: reimbursed market (Germany, Netherlands, Denmark, Australia), community pharmacy market (UK, France), total market (Canada, Japan, Switzerland, Sweden).

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2019–2025; most values 2023–2025); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: OECD Data Explorer (System of Health Accounts: retail pharmaceutical spending and financing; pharmaceutical market: generics); ECDC ESAC-Net and OECD (antibiotic consumption).